

Pantry Garden - Action Items & Summary

Meeting Date: January 9, 2026

Quick Stats & Highlights

- **2025 Harvest:** 2,722 lbs produced
 - **Volunteer Hours:** 800 hours
 - **Garden Plots:** 2 of 23 community plots at Anderson (only 2 doing soil improvement)
 - **Garden Started:** 2019
 - **Budget:** \$500 from County + Food Pantry Group + Larger Donors (Fire Fly, Arbor Systems)
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TO DO LIST

High Priority - Infrastructure

- ☐ Set up wash station with stainless steel table
- ☐ Document inventory of items
- ☐ Install French weave fencing between 8' tall posts
- ☐ Get forklift extender to move shed

High Priority - Tree & Plant Management

- ☐ Create management plan for fruit trees (Dog Park)
- ☐ Prune 30 fruit trees (timing critical)
- ☐ Empty compost bins - **2nd Saturday of April** (coordinate with Boy Scouts - 2 or possibly 3)

March - Planting Season

- ☐ Attend seeding event - **March 14 at Penny's**
- ☐ Submit seed wishlist to Farm & Fleet (donates seeds)
- ☐ Coordinate garlic donation from Keene Gardens for next fall
- ☐ Source potato coffee bags from roasters (Madison Food Pantry Garden connection)

April - Events

- ☐ Empty compost bins with Boy Scouts - **2nd Saturday of April**
- ☐ Plan Arbor Day Education event - **Last Thursday or Friday of April**

Ongoing - Garden Maintenance

- ☐ Address weed control strategy (add to future agenda)
- ☐ Implement better mulching system (consider old billboard material)
- ☐ Continue soil improvement practices
- ☐ Decide on fertilizer approach: Feather meal vs Bone meal vs UREA vs Cover Crops
 - Note: Fish emulsion is expensive (“Three Sisters and one fish”)

Communication & Planning

- ☐ Schedule next meeting in **early February**
- ☐ Write letter to local businesses requesting volunteers (“BADGER NEEDS ‘PANTRY’”)
- ☐ Research self-fed garden companion planting techniques
- ☐ Evaluate woolets effectiveness from last year

New Opportunities & Connections

- ☐ Follow up with Michael from Agricultural Institute KERUSA about ancient grain (new/ancient grain we could grow)
- ☐ Coordinate with Madison Area Food Pantry Garden for free compost
- ☐ Recruit volunteer groups through Parks Site

Equipment & Supplies Wishlist

- ☐ Create equipment dream list for Madison Area Food Pantry Garden
 - ☐ Organize cardboard inventory (we have lots)
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Meeting Notes Summary

Garden Operations

- Garden plots are managed by Rooted as part of Madison Area Food Pantry Gardens
- 23 community plots at Addison total; we manage 2 plots
- Only 2 plots (ours) are doing soil improvement
- SNAP benefits cutback will increase need in 2026
- Successfully grew 2,722 lbs of produce in 2025

Planting Strategy

Seed Selection Philosophy: “High yield = low effort” - Agricultural Education focus

Pepper Varieties:

- Rainbow peppers: not great performance
- Jalapeno: good
- Poblano: good

Planning Considerations:

- Potato growing in coffee bags (2-week timeframe)
- Garlic planting and coordination with Keeve Gardens
- Weed and mulch management needs improvement

Resources & Support

Financial:

- County budget: \$500
- Additional funding from Food Pantry Group
- Larger donors: FireFly, Arbor Systems

In-Kind Donations:

- Farm & Fleet: Seeds
- Madison Area Food Pantry Garden: Free compost, woolets (2025)
- Keene Gardens: Garlic donation (donated in 2025)

Materials Available:

- Large cardboard inventory
- Potential for old billboard material for mulching

Key Contacts & Partnerships

- **Michael** - Agricultural Institute KERUSA (ancient grain expert)
- **Rooted** - Garden management organization
- **Garman Community Farm** - New connection (downtown Oregon)
- **Farm & Fleet** - Seed donations
- **Keene Gardens** - Garlic donations
- **Madison Area Food Pantry Gardens** - Compost and supplies
- **Madison Food Pantry Garden** - Coffee bags from roasters

Notes for Future Agendas

- Weed control strategy discussion
- Equipment needs and wishlist review
- Volunteer recruitment and coordination
- Companion planting implementation
- Woolets effectiveness evaluation